

Delta² Lyrae
910 Suns

Sulafat
1,580 Suns

Sheliak
2,960 Suns

R Lyrae
The red giant variable R Lyrae ranges in brightness between magnitudes 3.9 and 5.0 every six or seven weeks

Epsilon (ε) Lyrae
This four-star family appears in binoculars as a wide double of 5th-magnitude stars. Telescopes can further divide each star into a close pair

Vega (α Lyrae)
The fifth-brightest star in the sky, Vega forms one corner of a large triangle in northern summer skies with Deneb in Cygnus and Altair in Aquila

M56
M56 is a faint, distant globular cluster, visible as a hazy patch through small telescopes

M57 (Ring Nebula)
The Ring Nebula is a planetary nebula about 2,000 light-years from Earth. It requires a telescope to be seen

KEY DATA

- Size ranking** 52
- Brightest stars** Vega (α)
0.0, Sulafat (γ) 3.3
- Genitive** Lyrae
- Abbreviation** Lyr
- Highest in sky at 10pm**
July–August
- Fully visible** 90°N–42°S



CHART 4

MAIN STARS

- Vega** Alpha (α) Lyrae
Blue-white main sequence
☼ 0.0 ↔ 25 light-years
- Sheliak** Beta (β) Lyrae
Blue-white giant; eclipsing binary
☼ 3.3–4.4 ↔ 960 light-years
- Sulafat** Gamma (γ) Lyrae
Blue-white giant
☼ 3.3 ↔ 620 light-years
- Delta¹ (δ¹) Lyrae**
Blue-white main sequence
☼ 5.6 ↔ 990 light-years
- Delta² (δ²) Lyrae**
Red giant
☼ 4.3 ↔ 740 light-years
- Epsilon¹ (ε¹) Lyrae**
Blue-white main sequence
☼ 4.7 ↔ 160 light-years
- Epsilon² (ε²) Lyrae**
Blue-white main sequence
☼ 4.6 ↔ 155 light-years
- Zeta (ζ) Lyrae**
Blue-white main sequence
☼ 4.4 ↔ 155 light-years
- R Lyrae**
Red giant variable
☼ 3.9–5.0 ↔ 300 light-years
- RR Lyrae**
White giant variable
☼ 7.1–8.1 ↔ 940 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

- M56**
Globular cluster, 8th magnitude
- M57 (Ring Nebula)**
Planetary nebula, 9th magnitude
- NGC 6745**
Pair of colliding galaxies

▼ **Star distances**
The closest of the pattern stars that make up Lyra is the also one of the brightest stars in the night sky. Vega is relatively close at 25 light-years, with the rest of the pattern stars all over 100 light-years distant. The most distant of the pattern stars is Eta Lyrae, which is nearly 1,400 light-years from Earth.

